IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 25, 2026

Record Close

Weekend Edition — Intel's blowout Q1 lifts AMD 14% and the S&P to a fresh all-time high as the extended ceasefire holds and Turkey considers Hormuz demining.

S&P 500 (FRI CLOSE)	BRENT (FRI CLOSE)	GOLD (FRI CLOSE)	AMD (FRI CLOSE)	FEAR & GREED
~7,139 · New ATH	~$105 · Drifting lower	~$4,765 ↑0.5%	$347.81 ↑13.91%	31 · Fear

SECTION 01

Markets — Weekend Edition

INTEL'S EARNINGS IGNITE THE BROADEST SEMICONDUCTOR RALLY OF THE YEAR

Friday closed a week defined by the semiconductor sleeve. Intel reported Q1 results after Thursday's close that exceeded expectations by the widest margin in years—non-GAAP EPS of $0.29 versus $0.013 consensus on revenue of $13.58 billion, per Yahoo Finance. The results validated x86 CPU demand for AI infrastructure and lifted the entire chip complex on Friday. AMD surged 13.91% to $347.81 after DA Davidson upgraded the stock to Buy, calling it the primary beneficiary of Intel's confirmation that x86 remains central to the AI build-out. QCOM rallied 11.12% to $148.85. IOWN's new Q2 additions were immediate contributors: CRDO gained 5.12% and VST added 4.78%. TSM rose 5.17%. Tech (+2.81%) was the dominant sector by a wide margin, with the S&P 500 closing at a fresh all-time high of approximately ~7,139. The Nasdaq surged 1.91%. Comm services (−1.58%) and healthcare (−1.41%) lagged. Fear & Greed improved to 31—continuing the steady recovery from the conflict's single-digit lows.

S&P 500	~7,139 · New all-time high close
AMD	$347.81 · ↑13.91% · Intel earnings + Barron's upgrade
QCOM	$148.85 · ↑11.12% · x86 AI validation
NEW HOLDINGS	CRDO +5.12% · VST +4.78% · Immediate contribution
BRENT CRUDE	~$105 · Drifting lower on peace progress
FEAR & GREED	31 · Steady improvement from conflict lows

Q2 REBALANCE POSITIONS ARE ALREADY WORKING

The portfolio rebalanced into Q2 with five new growth positions: CRDO, FCX, MRVL, VST, and the return of key names. Friday's session provided the first meaningful data point. CRDO gained 5.12% on the semiconductor tailwind, and VST added 4.78% as nuclear power demand for AI data centers continues to attract capital. On the dividend side, CTRA and NTR replace MATX and A, adding upstream energy and fertilizer crisis exposure. The thesis behind each addition—copper supercycle for FCX, optical interconnect for CRDO, custom silicon for MRVL, nuclear power for VST—aligns with IOWN's core conviction that physical infrastructure underpins the AI cycle. **The physical world matters.**

Intel's quarter proved that x86 is not a legacy architecture—it is the foundation the AI build-out requires. AMD's 14% move reflected the market absorbing that signal. The portfolio's semiconductor sleeve—AMD, TSM, CRDO, MRVL, NVDA, NXPI, KEYS, ADI—is positioned on the right side of that thesis. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

SECTION 02

Geopolitics

CEASEFIRE EXTENDED — BUT THE FRAMEWORK REMAINS FRAGILE

Trump extended the Iran ceasefire on April 21, citing a "seriously fractured" Iranian government and giving Tehran three to five days to engage in negotiations, per CNN and CNBC. The extension averted the feared April 21 expiry scenario that prior briefs identified as the week's primary risk. Trump stated Friday that Iran would make an offer aimed at satisfying US demands, per Reuters. However, Iran's Foreign Ministry denied that any meeting between negotiators is planned, and US negotiators heading to Islamabad have not been met by an Iranian delegation. The pattern persists: Trump signals progress while Iran denies engagement, yet the ceasefire holds in practice even as both sides accuse the other of violations. Turkey's foreign minister indicated Turkey may consider a role in Hormuz demining after a deal is reached—the first concrete reference to a post-conflict Hormuz infrastructure framework.

OIL CONTINUES TO DRIFT LOWER ON PEACE PROGRESS

Brent crude is trading near $105, continuing its retreat from the $115 highs of late March. WTI fell 1.72% on Friday. Reuters characterized Friday's session as "tech boosts US stocks to record close, oil dips on signs of Iran peace progress." The energy sleeve has transitioned from its war-premium leadership to a consolidation phase: VLO, CVX, and OKE are no longer the daily leaders but continue to generate elevated revenue from the structural supply disruption that persists even as the geopolitical risk premium compresses. The IEA's characterization of the conflict as the "biggest energy crisis in history" remains accurate regardless of the diplomatic trajectory—Hormuz transit has not normalized, and the physical infrastructure damage from strikes on Asaluyeh, Saudi refineries, and Gulf aluminum smelters will take years to repair.

CEASEFIRE	Extended April 21 · 3–5 day window for Iran response
TRUMP	Iran will make offer to satisfy US demands (Reuters)
IRAN POSITION	No meeting planned · FM denies engagement
TURKEY	May consider role in Hormuz demining post-deal
OIL	Brent ~$105 · Drifting lower · War premium compressing

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Week Ahead: AMD reports May 5, but the earnings calendar is heavy before then. GPC reports Monday. TEL reports Tuesday (the first new IOWN holding to report since the Q2 rebalance was finalized). SYK reports Wednesday. Alphabet and Microsoft report Tuesday and Wednesday respectively—their AI capex guidance will set the tone for the semiconductor sleeve. The Fed is in blackout ahead of the May 6–7 FOMC meeting. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. The ceasefire's 3–5 day engagement window from April 22 expires early this week. If Iran submits a proposal that addresses US nuclear demands, the diplomatic track could accelerate toward a formal agreement. If the window passes without engagement, Trump faces the same binary choice that has defined every prior deadline: extend again or resume strikes. The market has demonstrated it can hold at all-time highs through deadline uncertainty, but each cycle narrows the political space for further extensions. *Think Like an Owner.*

3. The bottom five tell the rotation story. HRMY (–3.99%), SSNC (–3.95%), and LMT (–3.08%) were Friday's laggards. Defense names (LMT) are fading as the ceasefire compresses the war premium. Healthcare (HRMY) and enterprise software (SSNC) are underperforming as capital rotates into semiconductors. The dividend sleeve's defensive names continue to provide floor-level returns while the growth sleeve captures the upside. **Simplicity Over Complexity.**

4. Fear & Greed at 31 is now closer to neutral than to the conflict lows. The index has improved from 8 at the March nadir to 31—a 23-point recovery that reflects genuine institutional repositioning. Goldman reported $86 billion in hedge fund buying two weeks ago. The remaining gap to neutral (50) represents the potential bid if the ceasefire produces a formal agreement. *Avoid Erosion.*

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